

THE HOLY R3UP



Trauma and the Spiritual Realm

A COMPLETE UNFILTERED WORKBOOK

You survived. Now we rebuild.

Built by a survivor.
Written for the ones still in the gap.

THE HOLY R3UP
BANDO TO VINEYARD

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Trauma and the Spiritual Realm



A COMPLETE UNFILTERED WORKBOOK
BUILT BY A SURVIVOR. WRITTEN FOR THE ONES STILL
IN THE GAP.

*For Brandi Renee – and for the one who finds this in
the middle of the night.*

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Trauma and the Spiritual Realm — A Complete Unfiltered Workbook

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PLEASE READ

This book is a faith-based companion for reflection and practice. It is not medical, mental-health, legal, or addiction-treatment advice, and it does not replace a doctor, therapist, counselor, pastor, or emergency services. The author is not a licensed clinician. Prayer belongs beside — not in place of — treatment, medication, safe housing, and safety planning.

YOUR SAFETY COMES FIRST

If you are in danger, call 911 (or your local emergency number). If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988 (U.S.). If you are physically dependent on alcohol, benzodiazepines, or barbiturates, do not stop suddenly without medical supervision — withdrawal can be dangerous. The resource page at the back of the book lists additional help. Phone numbers and services change; please confirm them before you rely on them.

ABOUT THE STORIES AND IDEAS

Personal testimony is shared as lived experience, not as a formula or a promise of any outcome. Interpretations of Scripture are labeled as interpretation and offered for you to test against the Bible and with wise, trusted people. Nothing in this book guarantees healing, deliverance, income, or any particular result.

SCRIPTURE

Scripture quotations are from the ESV® Bible (The Holy Bible, English Standard Version®), copyright © 2001 by Crossway, a publishing ministry of Good News Publishers. Used by permission. All rights reserved. Some verses are shortened with ellipses (...) or summarized; summaries are marked as references rather than quotations.

IN MEMORY

In Memory of Brandi Renee — 12787–121721

You survived. Now we rebuild.

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WHAT'S AHEAD

What's Ahead

I

TRAUMA — WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED TO YOU

Name what trauma did to your body, mind, and spirit; sort the lies it taught you; learn body-based resets you can use right away.

II

THE SPIRITUAL REALM — THE CRASH COURSE

A plain-language look at what Scripture says is real, how to sort body, wound, flesh, and spirit, and how to pray it through.

III

THE CHOSEN ONE — THE DEEP DIVE

What “chosen” and “called” mean in Scripture, what they cost, and how to tell calling from ego.

IV

SURVIVOR OF ADDICTION AND ABUSE

How the two braid together, what addiction was doing for you, naming abuse without softening it, and the moral injury nobody writes workbooks about.

V

ROADMAP: BREAKING ADDICTION

Ten steps, in order — honesty, medical care, a date, trigger chains, replacements, structure, cravings, a relapse plan, spiritual support, and milestones.

VI

ROADMAP: BREAKING GENERATIONAL CURSES

Map the patterns in your family, find where they may have started, and build the new behavior that prayer alone does not teach.

VII

LETTING PEOPLE GO, AND SITTING SILENT WITH GOD

Four kinds of letting go, grieving someone you lost to addiction, and a slow practice of silence for people whose nervous systems learned that quiet means danger.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

How to Read This Book

I am not a doctor, therapist, or pastor. I am a survivor who is still building, reaching back with what I have learned, what Scripture actually teaches, and something practical you can use. Four kinds of writing share these pages, and I want you to know which is which:

WHAT SCRIPTURE SAYS

Verses are quoted or cited by reference and read in context. Unless noted, quotations are from the ESV. When the Bible is clear, these pages say so plainly.

MY TESTIMONY

Places where I am sharing what I lived and what I am still learning. It is one woman's experience — not a rule for yours, and not a finished recovery story.

INTERPRETATION AND PRACTICE

Pictures like doors, contracts, stages, and seasons are ways of seeing and tools to practice with. Christians hold different views on some of them. Test them; keep what helps.

SYMBOL AND IMAGE

Broken chains, vineyards, anchors, and re-ups are pictures of freedom and renewal. A page of writing can help you practice something new. It does not, by itself, break a curse or change God's mind.

A FEW HONEST GROUND RULES

- You can skip any exercise. You can keep your eyes open. You can use a different anchor — a cold glass of water, your feet on the floor, a hand on a pet. You never have to relive something to complete a page.
- Prayers here are conversations with God, not formulas. Saying words out loud helps many people mean them; it does not force anything.
- Not every struggle is spiritual, and not every hard day is an attack. Sleep, food, pain, grief, and old wounds are real too. Sort them out with people who know you.
- Forgiving someone is not the same as trusting them again. Boundaries protect; they are not punishment. A relapse does not make you disposable.
- If a page opens more than you can carry, stop. Reach for a safe person or one of the numbers at the back. The page will wait.

This is for the person who knows something is wrong and doesn't know where to go.

This is for the one who got called "chosen" and found out it came with a price tag nobody warned them about.

This is for the one who is still breathing after what should have killed them.

You are not crazy. You are not cursed beyond reach. You are not too far in.

Turn the page.

How to Use This Workbook

This is not a devotional. This is not a feel-good study. This is a **work** book. There are blank lines because you are supposed to write in them. If you read it without writing, nothing changes.

Seven Parts:

Part	What it does
I	Trauma — what actually happened to your body, mind, and spirit
II	The Spiritual Realm — the crash course nobody gave you
III	The Chosen One — deep dive on the calling and its cost
IV	Survivor of Addiction and Abuse — naming it out loud
V	Roadmap: Breaking Addiction — step by step
VI	Roadmap: Breaking Generational Curses — step by step
VII	Roadmap: Letting People Go, and Sitting Silent With God

Rules of engagement:

1. Do it in order the first time. After that, go where the bleeding is.
2. Write by hand if you can. The hand knows things the mouth won't say.
3. Do not do this workbook at 2 a.m. alone your first time through. Pick daylight. Pick a day you have somewhere to go afterward.
4. If a page cracks you open and you can't close it, stop. Call someone. Come back tomorrow. The page will wait.

Before you start — the honest safety page:

- If you are in danger from another person right now, this workbook is not the first step. Getting safe is. **National Domestic Violence Hotline: 1-800-799-7233** (or text START to 88788).
- If you are thinking about ending your life: **call or text 988** (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, US). Do it before you do this workbook.
- If you are physically dependent on alcohol, benzodiazepines (Xanax, Klonopin, Ativan), or barbiturates, **do not quit cold on your own**. Withdrawal from those can kill you — seizures, delirium. That is not weakness, that is chemistry. You need a medical detox. **SAMHSA Helpline: 1-800-662-4357**, free, 24/7, confidential.
- Spiritual work and medical care are not enemies. God made doctors too. Deliverance does not cancel dosage. Do both.

PART I

Trauma: What Actually Happened to You

1.1 The definition they never gave you

Trauma is not the event. Trauma is what the event **left inside you** when your nervous system could not finish the response it needed to finish.

Say it plainer: something happened that was too much, too fast, too soon, or for too long, and you had no way out and nobody to run to. So your body did the only thing it could — it froze the moment and carried it.

You are not still reacting to the past. You are reacting to the **unfinished present** the past left in your body.

1.2 The four responses — and why yours wasn't a choice

Response	What it looks like	What it protected
Fight	Rage, arguing, provoking, control, "I'll ruin it before it ruins me"	Your right to exist
Flight	Leaving, moving, cutting off, ghosting, staying too busy to feel	Your body's exit
Freeze	Going blank, dissociating, watching yourself from the ceiling	Your mind, when the body couldn't run
Fawn	People-pleasing, over-apologizing, becoming useful to whoever is dangerous	Your life, by making you not-worth-hurting

Most abuse survivors are fawners who got called "sweet." Most addiction survivors are flighters who got called "unreliable." Most children of chaos are freezers who got called "spacey."

They were not personality traits. They were survival strategies that kept working after the danger left.

WORK PAGE 1 — NAME YOUR DEFAULT

Which of the four is your default? _____

When did you first learn it? (Age, place, who was in the room.)

What did it save you from?

Where is it costing you now?

Say out loud: "This kept me alive. It is no longer the only thing I have. Thank you. You can rest now."

1.3 The kinds of trauma — check what's yours

Mark everything that applies. Nobody is grading you. Nobody sees this but you and God.

- ☐ **Acute** — one event. A wreck. An assault. A night.
- ☐ **Chronic** — the same thing over and over. Years of it.
- ☐ **Complex (C-PTSD)** — repeated harm inside a relationship you couldn't leave. Childhood. Marriage. Trafficking. A church.
- ☐ **Developmental** — it happened while you were still being built, so it's in the foundation, not the walls.
- ☐ **Betrayal trauma** — the harm came from the one who was supposed to protect you. This is the one that breaks the ability to trust itself.
- ☐ **Sexual trauma** — your body was taken from you and you still live in it.
- ☐ **Religious / spiritual abuse** — Scripture used as a weapon. God's name on a hand that hit you. "Submit." "Forgive." "Don't be divisive."
- ☐ **Grief trauma** — a death you never got to finish grieving because life didn't stop.

- ☐ **Traumatic loss by addiction or suicide** — the specific hell of losing someone to the same thing that almost took you.
- ☐ **Medical trauma** — being held down, not believed, not medicated, not heard.
- ☐ **Institutional trauma** — CPS, courts, jail, rehab, foster care, a system that processed you instead of helping you.
- ☐ **Moral injury** — what YOU did that you can't reconcile with who you wanted to be. This is the one nobody makes workbooks for. We will.
- ☐ **Vicarious** — what you absorbed carrying everybody else's.

WORK PAGE 2 — THE INVENTORY NOBODY ASKED YOU FOR

Write the list. Not the story yet — the **list**. One line each. No details. Just titles, like chapters.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

Now circle the one you skipped. Write it here:

That's the one. That's where the work is. We're coming back to it.

1.4 What trauma does to the body (simplified, so you stop thinking you're broken)

Your body is not malfunctioning. It is running an old program on a current threat setting.

- **Amygdala** — your smoke alarm. After trauma it's set to go off at toast. Hypervigilance, startle, "I can read a room in three seconds."
- **Hippocampus** — your filing clerk. Trauma disrupts it, so the memory never gets filed as **past**. That's why it feels like now. That's a flashback. It is not weakness and it is not demonic — it is a filing error with a body attached.
- **Prefrontal cortex** — your reasoning. It goes offline under threat. That's why you "know better" and still do it. Knowing lives upstairs; the alarm lives downstairs; downstairs wins.
- **Vagus nerve** — your brake pedal. Trauma wears the brake. That's the shutdown, the numbness, the sudden exhaustion.
- **Cortisol and adrenaline** — the fuel. Years of it is why your stomach, your immune system, your sleep, your cycle, your teeth, your back all went down at once.

Trauma leaves its mark on the body. Talking helps, and for many people it is not enough by itself. You cannot think your way out of a body-level wound. You have to bring the body.

BODY-BASED RESETS (USE THESE ALL THROUGH THE WORKBOOK)

Learn these NOW, before the hard pages.

- 1. The 4-7-8 breath (drops the alarm)** In through the nose 4 counts. Hold 7. Out through the mouth 8, long and loud. Four rounds. The long exhale is the part that works.
- 2. 5-4-3-2-1 (ends a flashback)** Out loud: 5 things you see, 4 you can touch, 3 you hear, 2 you smell, 1 you taste. Then say the date and your age. "It is [today's date]. I am [your age]. That was then."
- 3. Cold water on the wrists and face (hard reset)** Can slow the heart rate fast. Works for many people when other things do not. (If you have a heart condition, ask your doctor before using cold water on your face.)
- 4. Orienting (tells the body the room is safe)** Slowly turn your head and look at every corner of the room. Let your eyes land on the exit. Your body needs to SEE there's a door.
- 5. Push the wall** Palms flat on a wall, push hard for 10 seconds, release. Gives the fight response somewhere to go.
- 6. Name it to tame it** "I am having a trauma response. This is not danger. This is memory."

WORK PAGE 3 — YOUR BODY MAP

Where does it live in your body? Mark it.

- Throat / can't speak: _____
- Chest / tight, can't breathe: _____
- Stomach / dread, nausea: _____
- Shoulders, jaw, fists: _____
- Hips / pelvis: _____
- Legs / want to run: _____
- Nowhere — numb, can't feel it: _____

For the loudest spot, answer: **If it could talk, what would it say?**

How old does it sound? _____

That's who you're actually working with. Not a disorder. A kid.

1.5 Trauma's beliefs — the lies it installed

Trauma doesn't just hurt you. It **teaches** you. Check what got installed:

- ☐ It was my fault.
- ☐ I should have known.
- ☐ I'm too much.
- ☐ I'm not enough.
- ☐ If they knew the real me they'd leave.
- ☐ Love always costs.
- ☐ Safe is boring; chaos is home.
- ☐ I only matter when I'm useful.
- ☐ I can't trust myself.
- ☐ God let it happen, so God allowed it, so God is not safe.
- ☐ I'm the family's problem.
- ☐ If I stop moving, it catches me.
- ☐ I don't get to want things.

- ☐ I'm already ruined, so it doesn't matter what I do now.

WORK PAGE 4 — LIE / EVIDENCE / TRUTH

Take your top three. Fill this out honestly — do not give the Sunday School answer.

Lie #1: _____

Who taught it to me (name or situation): _____

Evidence I have used to keep believing it:

Evidence against it (make yourself find one thing):

Scripture or truth I am choosing to stand on instead:

What it would change if I actually believed the truth:

(Repeat for #2 and #3.)

Truth anchors for this section:

- Psalm 34:18 — "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted and saves the crushed in spirit."
- Psalm 56:8 — He keeps count of your tossings; He puts your tears in a bottle. Your crying was **recorded**, not ignored.
- Isaiah 61:1–3 — binding up the brokenhearted, beauty for ashes, oil of joy for mourning. The exchange is the whole point.
- Romans 8:1 — no condemnation. Not "less." **None.**

1.6 The part nobody will say out loud

Some of what happened to you was not your fault AND some of what you did afterward was. Both are true at once. Holding only the first makes you a permanent victim. Holding only the second makes you a person who can't stop punishing themselves.

You need both hands.

WORK PAGE 5 — THE TWO COLUMNS

What was DONE to me (not mine to carry)	What I DID (mine to own and be forgiven for)

Look at column one. Say: **"I set this down. It was never mine."**

Look at column two. Say: **"I own this. I am not condemned for it. I will make it right where I can."**

That's it. That's the whole difference between shame and repentance. Shame says *I am bad*.
Repentance says *I did bad, and I'm not staying there*.

PART II

The Spiritual Realm: The Crash Course

2.1 Start here: there are two realms and one is more real

The physical realm is what you can measure. The spiritual realm is what generates it.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"We look not to the things that are seen but to the things that are unseen. For the things that are seen are transient, but the things that are unseen are eternal." — 2 Corinthians 4:18

"For we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the cosmic powers over this present darkness." — Ephesians 6:12

Paul is describing something real: **an opposing spiritual reality, with structure and strategy — and a limit.** Christians hold a range of views on the details, and Scripture gives us less of a map than we sometimes wish. What it gives us clearly is Jesus.

2.2 The three-way error most people make

Error	What it sounds like	Why it wrecks you
Everything is demonic	"The devil gave me depression."	You spend years binding a spirit that was a thyroid, a trauma loop, or a bad marriage. Nothing improves, so you conclude God failed.
Nothing is spiritual	"It's all just psychology."	You white-knuckle a war you can't see and lose ground you don't know you're standing on.
It's spiritual so I don't need help	"I just need more faith."	You die of something treatable while praying.

Our working position: it is often more than one thing at once, and you work on every part that is there.

A wound can be real trauma, and it can also be a place where lies and temptation find footing. A craving can be real neurochemistry, and it can also be a pull toward a false comfort. Treat the body. Tend the wound. Take the spiritual side to God. You do not have to decide which one it "really" is before you start getting help.

2.3 What's actually in the realm

God — not a force, a Person. Sovereign, present, the only one with unlimited authority. Not the author of what was done to you.

The Holy Spirit — God living *in* you if you're His. Your comfort, your conviction, your power, your discernment. Conviction feels like clean grief and points to a specific thing with a way out. Condemnation feels like drowning and points at your whole self with no exit. **Learn the difference. It will save you years.**

Jesus — the one who already won. Colossians 2:15: He disarmed the powers and made a public spectacle of them. This matters because it means you are not fighting for a victory — you are **enforcing** one.

Angels — messengers and warriors. Sent. Not summoned by you, not worshiped by you.

Satan — a created being. Fallen. Limited. A liar (John 8:44), a thief (John 10:10), an accuser (Revelation 12:10). **He is not omnipresent and he is not the opposite of God.** Scripture never says he can read minds; only God knows the heart (1 Kings 8:39).

The enemy's forces — Ephesians 6:12 names rulers, authorities, cosmic powers, and spiritual forces, and Colossians 2:15 says Christ disarmed them. Scripture says far less about how they work than people online pretend. You do not need a map of ranks. You need Jesus, honest people, and discernment — and you need to hold back from calling a hard experience demonic just because it is hard. A pattern that follows you from place to place, or runs through a whole family, is worth taking seriously, and worth bringing to a doctor, a counselor, and a trusted pastor together.

Your own flesh — Galatians 5. Not a demon. Your untrained appetite. **Most of what people try to cast out, they need to crucify.** You cannot rebuke a habit you keep feeding.

WORK PAGE 6 — SORTING YOUR OWN SITUATION

Take the thing tormenting you most. Answer:

What part of this is body / brain / chemistry? (Needs care, sleep, food, meds, doctor.)

What part is wound? (Needs healing, grief, truth, maybe a therapist.)

What part is flesh? (Needs discipline, boundaries, no.)

What part is spiritual? (Needs renouncing, authority, closing a door.)

Now you have four assignments instead of one impossible one. That's what discernment is for.

2.4 What keeps feeding the struggle

Some struggles keep getting fed by the same things. Naming them is not meant to shame you — it gives you something you can change. Christians disagree about how much of this is spiritual, so use what helps and hold the rest loosely.

Check honestly:

- ☐ **Unforgiveness / bitterness** (Matthew 18:34–35 — the jailer. Hebrews 12:15 — the root.) Very common in survivors, and very understandable.
- ☐ **Agreement with a lie** — "I'm worthless" is a lie you have been rehearsing, and it needs replacing with truth.
- ☐ **Occult contact** — tarot, mediums, Ouija, spells, santería, crystals for power, "harmless" psychics, astrology as authority, rituals you did as a kid for protection because nobody else was protecting you.
- ☐ **Sexual entanglements ("soul ties")** — 1 Corinthians 6:16 says sexual union joins two people. What was done to you against your will was a wrong done to you, not a sin of yours — and it can still leave a hold on your mind and body that is worth bringing to God and a counselor. ("Soul tie" is not a phrase in Scripture; it is a name many believers use for this experience.)
- ☐ **Family patterns** — sin and wounds running through generations (Exodus 20:5, Lamentations 5:7).
- ☐ **Vows and self-curses** — "I will never love anyone again." "I'll always be like my mother." "I hope I die." Those are promises you made in pain.
- ☐ **Substances** — altering the mind lowers your guard, and addiction can rule a life like an idol. (Galatians 5:20 lists sorcery — *pharmakeia* — next to idolatry; Scripture's concern is what rules you, not medicine taken under a doctor's care.)
- ☐ **Trauma itself** — a wound can leave you more exposed and more alone. That is not your fault, and it is something you are allowed to tend.
- ☐ **What you consume** — what you watch, hear, scroll, and replay at night is a diet, and it feeds something.
- ☐ **Things done or spoken over you by others** — dedications, harsh words from family, things you don't fully remember.

WORK PAGE 7 — THE PATTERN LIST

List everything you can identify. Next to it, write **"BROUGHT TO GOD"** once you've prayed through it in 2.6, or **"WORKING ON IT"** if you're not there yet.

Pattern	How it started	Status

2.5 Your actual authority — read this twice

You are not begging. You are not negotiating. You are not equal-and-opposite.

- **Luke 10:19** — "I have given you authority to tread on serpents and scorpions... and nothing shall hurt you."
- **Ephesians 2:6** — you are seated *with Him in the heavenly places*. Positional. Above, not below.
- **James 4:7** — submit to God, THEN resist the devil. **That order is not optional.** Resisting without submitting is how people get hurt.
- **1 John 4:4** — greater is He in you than he in the world.
- **Revelation 12:11** — they conquered by the blood of the Lamb and the word of their testimony. **Your story matters.** Telling the truth about what happened to you — to safe people, at your own pace — takes the power out of secrecy.

What authority is not: a volume contest. You don't need to scream. Jesus rebuked with a sentence. Loud is for your own fear, not for their ears.

2.6 Praying it through — renouncing, forgiving, and handing it to God

Before you pray this: these prayers are a faith practice, not a formula. Scripture invites us to confess, forgive, resist the devil, and pray out loud with others (James 4:7; 5:16), but it does not hand us a script, and nothing here replaces a doctor, a counselor, or a pastor who knows you. You are allowed to skip any step that

stirs up more than you can hold. Saying the words aloud helps many people mean them. Do it with one trustworthy believer present if you can. If you can't, you can still pray it alone.

Step 1 — Get under cover.

PRAYER

"Father, I come to You through Jesus Christ, who died for me and rose again. I am Yours. I submit myself to You — my body, my mind, my memory, my will, my future. I need You for this, not my own strength. Cover me in the blood of Jesus."

Step 2 — Confess what's yours.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I confess my part. Not what was done to me — my part. [Name it specifically. No lists of 'anything and everything.' Be specific. Specific is where power is.] I repent. I turn from it. I receive Your forgiveness, and I refuse to keep paying for what You already paid for."

Step 3 — Forgive, by name.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I choose to forgive [name]. Not because it was okay. It was not okay. Because I refuse to be their jailer and their prisoner at the same time. I release them to You and out of my hands. I take back what I gave them access to. I cancel the debt I have been trying to collect."

(This will not feel true the first time. Do it anyway. Feeling follows obedience, sometimes by months.)

Step 4 — Renounce what you've named.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"In the name of Jesus Christ I renounce [each item from Work Page 7, one at a time, out loud]. I break every agreement I made with it, knowingly or unknowingly. I take my hand off it, and I ask You to close that door and seal it with the blood of Jesus."

Step 5 — Break vows and self-curses.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I break every vow I made in pain. Specifically: [say each one]. I renounce it. I release myself from it in Jesus' name. It has no more claim on my life."

Step 6 — Release what is not yours.

PRAYER

"Jesus, I release my hold on [name, or 'the one whose name I don't know'], and I ask You to loosen their hold on me. I hand back what is theirs. I take back what is mine — my body, my mind, my peace, my identity, my future. What God did not join, I do not keep."

Step 7 — Resist (optional). *If you believe something spiritual has been pressing on you, talk it through with a pastor or counselor you trust first. Scripture's instruction is simple: submit to God, resist the devil, and he will flee (James 4:7). Skip this step if it stirs up more than you can hold.*

PRAYER

"Jesus, I belong to You. Anything that is not from You — any lie, fear, or influence that took hold through what I have named — has no place in my life, my home, or my family. In Your name I resist it, and I ask You to send it away. I am Yours. Holy Spirit, stay with me. Amen."

Step 8 — Fill it. Do not skip this. Luke 11:24–26 is Jesus' picture of a swept house left empty, and the practical lesson is that when something leaves your life, something good has to move in.

PRAYER

"Holy Spirit, fill every place that just emptied. Fill it with Your presence, Your peace, Your truth, Your love. Where fear lived, put love. Where shame lived, put sonship. Where craving lived, put satisfaction. Occupy every room."

Step 9 — Declare.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I belong to God. I am forgiven, I am free, and I am not going back. What tried to end me is going to be the testimony that frees somebody else. In Jesus' name. Amen."

WORK PAGE 8 — DATE IT

I did the renouncing on: ____ / ____ / ____

Who was with me: _____

What I felt in my body during and after:

What came up for me in the days after (write it — naming what comes up makes it easier to face):

Expect a rough few days. Old contacts texting. Old dreams. A wave of grief. A craving with a new face. This kind of work stirs things up. That is not proof it worked and it is not proof it failed — it is proof you touched something real. Sleep, eat, stay near your people, and tell your counselor or one safe person. Not every hard day is a spiritual attack, and you do not have to decide what caused it before you ask for help.

2.7 The armor — daily, not occasionally

Ephesians 6:14–18. Many believers put it on out loud, every morning, thirty seconds:

- **Belt of truth** — "I will not lie to myself today."
- **Breastplate of righteousness** — "I am covered by His, not mine."
- **Shoes of peace** — "I bring peace into rooms; I don't take chaos from them."
- **Shield of faith** — "Every lie aimed at me today, I put this in front of."
- **Helmet of salvation** — "My mind belongs to God. I don't have to think every thought that shows up."
- **Sword of the Spirit** — "The Word is my answer, not my feelings."
- **Prayer** — "I stay in conversation, not monologue."

Notice: **no armor on the back.** You're not built to run. You're built to stand, and to stand with others.

PART III

The Chosen One: The Deep Dive

3.1 First, the correction

The internet sold "chosen one" as special. Scripture sells it as **sent**.

Chosen is not a rank. It is an **assignment**. It does not mean God likes you more. It means God has something for you to carry that most people will not carry, and He is going to prepare you for it in ways that will look, from the outside, like He abandoned you.

*"You did not choose me, but I chose you and appointed you that you should go and bear fruit."
— John 15:16*

Appointed **that you should go**. Chosen is a verb with a destination.

3.2 A pattern you can see in many of them

Look at the pattern and see whether you recognize yourself in it:

Who	The early wound	The wilderness	The assignment
Joseph	Betrayed and trafficked by his own blood	13 years — slavery, false accusation, prison, forgotten	Saved the nations, and the family that sold him
Moses	Born under a death order, raised in the enemy's house, identity split	40 years on the back side of the desert after a killing	Led a whole people out
David	Overlooked youngest, left with sheep	Years hunted by the king who was supposed to bless him	King, and the voice of everyone who ever cried out
Hannah	Barren, mocked, misunderstood — the priest thought she was drunk while she prayed	Years of unanswered asking	Gave the nation its prophet
Esther	Orphan, taken into a king's harem — she was not "picked," she was collected	Hidden, silent, one wrong move from death	Stopped a genocide
Paul	Was the abuser first. Blood on his hands.	Blinded, then years unknown in Arabia and Tarsus	Wrote most of the New Testament
Jesus	Rumored illegitimate, refugee child, hometown rejection	40 days of hunger and direct temptation	Everything

The pattern:

1. Marked early — often by wound, not by celebration.
2. Isolated — removed from the people who should have carried you.
3. Delayed — longer than you can stand.
4. Misunderstood — called crazy, drunk, dramatic, too much, divisive.
5. Broken in a specific spot — the exact place your assignment will require humility.

6. Then used — and often the fruit comes in the shape of the wound.

Read that last one again: often, the fruit comes in the shape of the wound. Not always, and not automatically. Scripture never tells us every wound is an assignment, and it never says God planned the harm. It does show Him bringing good out of it (Genesis 50:20).

Joseph's assignment was famine and family. He was starved of family. Moses' assignment was deliverance. He was the one who got delivered out of the water. Paul's assignment was grace. He was the one who least deserved it.

Your story may point toward what you are meant to do — look at where your wound and your compassion overlap. That is interpretation, not a guarantee. Hold it loosely and test it with mature people.

WORK PAGE 9 — READING YOUR OWN STORY

What was attacked earliest in my life?

What did they try hardest to take from me? (Voice? Body? Innocence? Family? Mind? Faith?)

What do people keep coming to me about, even when I feel unqualified?

What makes me furious in a way that isn't about me? (Holy anger is a compass.)

What could I explain to someone in the dark that a person with a normal life could never explain?

Look at those five answers together. **They may point toward something you are meant to do.** Write it in one sentence:

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I am the one who _____
for the people who _____."

3.3 The cost of being chosen – the unfiltered list

Nobody prints this part. Here it is.

1. Isolation that isn't punishment. You will lose people. Some you'll grieve for years. Not all of it is attack — some of it may be God clearing a table so He can seat the right people at it. But it will feel identical to abandonment. Both can be true.

2. Being misunderstood by good people. Not just enemies. Pastors. Family. Friends who love you. They will call your calling pride, your grief drama, your boundaries bitterness, your urgency instability.

3. Delay that looks like denial. Joseph, thirteen years. Moses, forty. You will get a promise and then watch the opposite happen for a long time. **The promise doesn't fail in the delay. It gets forged there.**

4. A season that feels out of proportion. If it has been *weirdly* much, that does not mean you are cursed — and it does not prove you are carrying something special, either. Some seasons are just brutal. Ask for help either way.

5. Repeat temptation at the same fault line. Whatever nearly took you out will come back with a suit on. Often when you step up, it will knock. Not because you failed. Because it's the known door.

6. Being made to carry it without credit. Sometimes you will do the thing and someone else will get thanked. If you need the credit, you cannot carry the weight.

7. The loneliness of the middle. Too healed for your old crowd. Too raw for the polished ones. That gap is where most called people quit. **You are not supposed to stay in the gap. You are supposed to build in it.** That's what 7HE HOLY R3UP is for.

8. Grief that comes back on a schedule. Anniversaries. Songs. Smells. Being chosen does not exempt you from missing the ones you lost. The absence of someone you lost does not get smaller because the work is real. It gets *carried better*. Different thing.

WORK PAGE 10 — COUNTING THE COST HONESTLY

What has this already cost me?

What am I still unwilling to pay? (Be honest. God can work with honest.)

What am I demanding from God as a condition? ("I'll do it if You give me _____.")

Who did I lose that I need to grieve instead of chase?

3.4 Counterfeits — how to tell calling from ego

The "chosen one" idea gets hijacked constantly. Run your sense of calling through this grid:

Real calling	Counterfeit
Points people to God	Points people to you
Survives being unseen	Requires an audience
Comes with correction you accept	Rejects all correction as persecution
Makes you more approachable	Makes you more untouchable
Confirmed by fruit and by mature people	Confirmed only by your own feelings
Welcomes accountability	Calls accountability jealousy
Grows in obscurity	Dies in obscurity
Says "this happened TO me and God is using it"	Says "this happened because I'm superior"
Wants others free	Wants others dependent

The test that never fails: Can you be corrected? A chosen person who can't be corrected is the most dangerous person in any room, and there are a lot of them with microphones.

WORK PAGE 11 — THE MIRROR

Who in my life is allowed to tell me I'm wrong? (If the answer is nobody, that's the assignment for this month.)

Last time I was corrected, how did I respond?

Do I need to be needed? Where does that show up?

3.5 The transition: from victim to survivor to steward

Three stages. Most people stall at two.

Victim — "This happened to me." True. Necessary. You must be allowed to be here. Skipping it is how people end up doing ministry out of an open wound.

Survivor — "This happened to me and I'm still here." Strength. Also a place you can get stuck, because "still here" can become an identity built on the thing that hurt you. If your whole self is *what you survived*, the abuser still owns the deed.

Steward — "This happened to me, I'm still here, and now it belongs to God and it's for somebody else." This is where the wound stops being a hole and becomes a door.

"Who comforts us in all our affliction, so that we may be able to comfort those who are in any affliction." — 2 Corinthians 1:4

The "so that" is the whole thing. You were not comforted so you'd feel better. You were comforted so you'd know the road.

WORK PAGE 12 — WHERE AM I?

Circle: **Victim / Survivor / Steward** — and be honest, it may differ by area.

Area of my life	Which stage	What's the next step
Addiction		
Abuse		
Family		
Grief		
Faith		
Body		

One thing I can steward this week — not someday, this week:

PART IV

Survivor of Addiction and Abuse

4.1 The truth about how the two braid together

Addiction and abuse are not two separate problems that happened to the same person. They feed each other.

Abuse creates the hole. Addiction fills it. Addiction then puts you in rooms where more abuse happens. More abuse deepens the hole. Around and around.

This is why "just stop using" fails. You are not asking someone to drop a habit. You are asking them to sit in an unmedicated wound with no skills and no safety. Of course they went back. Anyone would.

Which means: you cannot get sober and heal the trauma later. You have to run them together. Sobriety without trauma work is a countdown. Trauma work while actively using is a spin cycle. Both, at once, slowly.

4.2 What addiction actually is

Three layers. Work all three or it comes back.

Layer 1 — Physical. Real dependence. Real receptors. Real withdrawal. Requires medical help sometimes. Not a moral issue.

Layer 2 — Psychological. The relief. Addiction is not a love of the substance. It is a love of the *gap in the pain*. It worked. That's the problem — it worked, right up until it started charging interest.

Layer 3 — Spiritual. Every addiction is a false savior. It promises what only God gives: peace, escape, belonging, numbness from shame, courage, rest. It's a counterfeit communion.

"My people have committed two evils: they have forsaken me, the fountain of living waters, and dug for themselves cisterns — broken cisterns that can hold no water." — Jeremiah 2:13

The cistern isn't the sin. **Digging your own** is.

WORK PAGE 13 — WHAT WAS IT DOING FOR YOU?

This is the most important question in the whole workbook. Answer it slowly.

What did it give me that I couldn't get anywhere else?

What did it let me stop feeling?

Who was I when I was using? (Sometimes people use to access a self they can't reach sober — confident, loud, calm, wanted.)

What was the first time it worked? (Age, situation.)

Now the hard one: If I take it away and don't replace the function, what happens?

That's your relapse map. You don't just need to remove the substance. You need a legitimate answer for every job it was doing. Write those jobs down; Part V builds replacements for each.

4.3 Abuse: naming it without softening it

Check what happened. Not "was it bad enough." Just — did it happen.

- ☐ Hit, shoved, choked, restrained, thrown
- ☐ Threatened, with words or weapons or a look
- ☐ Sexually coerced, assaulted, or used
- ☐ Trafficked, sold, traded, "loaned out"
- ☐ Controlled — money, phone, car, friends, food, sleep
- ☐ Isolated from anyone who would have helped
- ☐ Degraded, mocked, called names until you believed them
- ☐ Gaslit — told your memory was wrong until you stopped trusting your own head

- ☐ Love-bombed then withdrawn, on a cycle, until the cycle became the drug
- ☐ Punished for having needs
- ☐ Blamed for their behavior
- ☐ Threatened with your kids, your freedom, your reputation, your life
- ☐ Neglected as a child — nobody came
- ☐ Spiritually abused — Scripture used to keep you in it
- ☐ Made to feel crazy for reacting normally to abnormal treatment

THE SPECIFIC DAMAGE OF BETRAYAL BY FAMILY

If the hand that hurt you was supposed to feed you, you didn't just get injured. **Your instrument for detecting safety got miscalibrated at the factory.** That's why you can smell danger from a mile away and still walk straight into it. Your alarm works. Your *identifier* is broken. You learned that harm and love arrive in the same package.

That is fixable. It is not fixable by trying harder. It is fixable by building new evidence, slowly, with safe people, over time.

WORK PAGE 14 — THE LETTER YOU WILL NEVER SEND

Write it to the one who did the most damage. Nobody reads it. You can burn it after.

Rules: no editing for fairness. No "but they had a hard life too." Not yet. Rage allowed. Raw words allowed. God's not scandalized; He's read worse in the Psalms (go read Psalm 55 or 109 if you don't believe me).

Start with: **"What you took from me was..."**

Now end it with one line, whenever you're able — not today if not today:

"I am not sending you my life as payment anymore."

4.4 Moral injury – the page nobody writes

Some of you are not haunted by what was done to you. You're haunted by **what you did while you were surviving**.

What you did to get well. Who you hurt to get high. The kid who watched. The people you stole from. The ones you brought into it. The times you were the dangerous one.

Here is the truth, unfiltered: **that was real, and it is not unforgivable**. Paul stood by at Stephen's stoning and went on to persecute believers (Acts 7:58–8:3). God did not just forgive him — God *commissioned* him and had him write letters we still read. Not despite it. He referenced it constantly. It was his credential for grace.

But forgiveness is not the same as amends. You get forgiven by God. You make it right with people where you safely can. Two different tracks. Do both.

WORK PAGE 15 — MORAL INJURY INVENTORY

What I did	Who it hurt	Can I make it right?	How / or why not

"Can I make it right?" — sometimes the answer is no: they're gone, contact is unsafe, or approaching them would harm them more. **When you can't make direct amends, you make living amends.** You become someone who doesn't do that anymore, and you serve where that damage lives.

What I can't fix directly, I will pay forward by:

Receive this out loud: "I did that. It was mine. Jesus paid for it. I am not going to keep punishing someone He already pardoned."

PART V

Roadmap: Breaking Addiction

Step by step. In order. No skipping.

THE HOLY R3UP

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Safety first: alcohol, benzos, and barbiturates can kill you in withdrawal. Opioid withdrawal won't usually kill you but it will make you want to die, and MAT (Suboxone, methadone, naltrexone) is a legitimate, not-cheating, God-honoring tool. **Get a medical opinion before Step 1. SAMHSA: 1-800-662-4357.**

Step 1 – Tell One Person the Actual Truth

Not a version. The truth. What, how much, how often, how long, how bad.

Why this is step one: addiction lives in secrecy. Every single thing you keep hidden keeps its power. Confession is not humiliation — it's cutting off the oxygen.

"Confess your sins to one another and pray for one another, that you may be healed." – James 5:16

Pick who: someone who (a) won't panic, (b) won't gossip, (c) won't use it against you later, (d) won't minimize it. Sponsor, counselor, pastor you trust, one friend who's been through it.

Do it in the next 48 hours.

- Person I'm telling: _____
- When: _____
- Done: ☐

Step 2 – Get the Medical Picture

Call SAMHSA or a doctor. Ask four questions:

1. Is my withdrawal dangerous?
2. Do I need supervised detox?
3. Is MAT right for me?
4. What else is going on — sleep, thyroid, nutrition, depression, ADHD, pain?

Untreated mental health conditions are a common driver of relapse. If you've been self-medicating something real, taking away the medication without treating the condition is not sobriety. It's a stopwatch.

- Called: ☐ Date: _____
- What they said: _____
- Next appointment: _____

Step 3 – Set a Date and Clear the Runway

Not "someday." A date. Within 14 days.

My date: ____ / ____ / ____

Before the date, do all of this:

- ☐ **Remove it all.** Every stash, every backup, every "just in case." Dispose of it safely (many pharmacies take pills back). Have someone with you.
 - ☐ **Remove the tools.** Pipes, needles, bottles, the app, the browser history, the card you use.
 - ☐ **Delete and block every dealer and drinking buddy.** All of them. Screenshot nothing. Keep no number "just to say no."
 - ☐ **Tell three people the date.** Accountability is a fence, not an insult.
 - ☐ **Clear the calendar for the first 72 hours.** No obligations. No driving if you can avoid it.
 - ☐ **Stock the house.** Water, electrolytes, easy food, sugar, fruit, something soft to sleep on, a fan, a bucket, ibuprofen.
 - ☐ **Decide where you go if the house isn't safe.** Write the address: _____
 - ☐ **Line up day 1, 2, and 3.** A meeting, a person, a phone call at a set time. Empty time is where it gets you.
-

Step 4 – Map the Trigger Chain

Relapse is never one moment. It's a chain with 6–10 links, and every link before the last one is easier to break.

Fill this out for your most common relapse:

Link	Yours
1. Setting (where, what time of day)	
2. Emotional state (bored? lonely? angry? celebrating?)	
3. Body state (tired? hungry? in pain? not slept?)	
4. The thought that starts it	
5. The justification ("I've earned it," "one won't...", "nobody cares anyway")	
6. The first action (a text, a drive, a search)	
7. The point of no return	
8. The use	
9. The aftermath	

Now: circle link 3 or 4. **That's where you intervene from now on.** Not link 7. By link 7 you already decided; you just hadn't admitted it.

My earliest detectable link is: _____ **When I notice it, I will immediately:**

HALT check — run it 3x/day. Hungry, Angry, Lonely, Tired. Most relapses are three of those stacked and none of them are actually about the substance.

Step 5 – Replace the Function

Go back to Work Page 13. For every job the substance did, write a legitimate replacement. This is non-negotiable — you cannot leave a vacancy.

Job it did	Legitimate replacement	When I'll do it
Numbed pain		
Gave energy		
Helped me sleep		
Made me social / confident		
Gave me something to look forward to		
Quieted my head		
Punished me		
Gave me a community		

Replacements that actually work on the nervous system: exercise (one of the best-supported ways to ease a craving in real time), cold water, heavy lifting, running, sunlight in the first hour awake, real food, 8 hours attempted, service to someone else, loud worship, a phone call, a saw or a paintbrush or something with your hands, drums, singing, dancing in your kitchen like a fool.

Replacements that don't: scrolling, a new relationship, overwork, sugar as a whole strategy, isolation with a Bible you're reading like a hostage.

Step 6 – Build the Structure (the First 90 Days)

Sobriety is not willpower. It's architecture.

Daily non-negotiables — write your own version:

Time	What	Why
Wake	Same hour, feet on floor, sunlight	Body-clock reset; losing sleep is a major relapse risk
First 10 min	Prayer out loud + armor (2.7)	Set the day before it sets you
Morning	Protein + water before caffeine	Blood sugar crashes read as cravings
Midday	Move your body 20+ min	Chemistry, not vanity
Afternoon	HALT check + text your person	Breaks the chain early
Evening	Meeting / call / group 5x week minimum first 90 days	Isolation is the killer
Night	Same bedtime. Phone out of the room.	Protect the sleep or lose the war
Before sleep	Gratitude, 3 things, out loud	Rewires the negativity groove

Weekly:

- ☐ One recovery meeting minimum (AA/NA/Celebrate Recovery/SMART/church group — whatever you'll actually attend)
- ☐ One check-in with sponsor/mentor
- ☐ One therapy session if you can access it
- ☐ One act of service — small, anonymous
- ☐ One full rest day

The 90-day rule: for the first 90 days, no major decisions. No new relationships. No moving. No quitting jobs. No going back to fix your family. (If safety or housing is at stake, safety comes first.) Your judgment is recovering too and it comes back last.

STEP 7 – CRAVING PROTOCOL (*memorize this*)

A craving often peaks within 15–30 minutes and then fades, even when it does not feel like it will. You only have to outlast a wave.

When it hits:

1. **Say it out loud.** "I am having a craving. It is 10:40. It will peak and pass."
2. **Set a timer for 20 minutes.** You are not deciding anything until it rings.
3. **Change your body.** Cold water on wrists/face. 20 pushups. Walk out the front door.
4. **Change your location.** Do not stay in the room where it started.
5. **Call.** Not text. Voice. Have three numbers memorized and one who always answers.
6. **Eat and drink.** Water and protein. Half your cravings are blood sugar.
7. **Pray specific and short.** "Jesus, I can't do this minute. You hold it." Not eloquent. Effective.

8. **Play the tape forward.** Not the first hour. The 48th. The phone call you'd have to make. The face of the person you'd have to tell. Write it now so it's ready:

My play-the-tape-forward, written in advance:

If I use today, within 48 hours I will: _____

The person whose face I'll see is: _____

What I will have thrown away: _____

9. **When the timer rings, reset it once if needed.** You almost never need a third.

My three numbers:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

STEP 8 – RELAPSE PLAN (write it now, not after)

Having a plan does not give permission. Not having one gives the relapse a runway.

"The righteous falls seven times and rises again." – Proverbs 24:16 The identity is in the rising, not the not-falling.

If I use:

1. I stop at the first one. The relapse is the first use; the *run* is the decision after it.
2. Within 1 hour I tell: _____
3. I go to: _____ (a meeting, a person, a room that's safe)
4. I do NOT hide it, and I do NOT declare myself a failure. I do not throw away 60 days over one day.
5. I get medical help if needed — **tolerance drops during sobriety, and that's how overdoses happen after a clean stretch.** Know this. Tell whoever you use around. Have naloxone (Narcan) in the house if opioids are in your history. Free at most pharmacies.
6. I go back to Step 4 and find the link I missed, and I write it down.

What I will NOT do after a relapse:

Step 9 – The Spiritual Side of the Same War

Run these alongside Steps 1–8, never instead of.

- ☐ **Renounce the addiction as a false god by name.** "I renounce [substance/behavior] as my savior, my comfort, and my god. It is not my provider. Jesus is." (Full renouncing in 2.6.)
- ☐ **Break the agreements.** "I am an addict and I always will be" — decide what you actually believe. *I have an addiction* is a fact. *I am worthless because of it* is a lie. Break the second, respect the first.
- ☐ **Close the doors** the using opened — people, places, sexual ties, occult contact, what you watched and listened to in that life.
- ☐ **Fast something, on purpose, on a schedule.** Social media. Sugar. Screens. A meal, only if your doctor says it is safe for you — skip food fasting if you are pregnant, diabetic, have an eating-disorder history, or take medication with meals. Fasting practices the muscle of telling a craving no.
- ☐ **Get baptized or re-affirm it** if that's part of your story. Mark the line. Bodies need markers.
- ☐ **Take communion regularly.** You had a false communion for years. Replace the ritual with the real one.
- ☐ **Worship loud when it's bad.** 2 Chronicles 20 — they sent the singers out front, before the army.
- ☐ **Get someone to lay hands and pray over you.** Don't do this whole war solo.

Step 10 – Milestones and Meaning

Track it. Visibly. Days matter and your brain needs the count.

Milestone	Date reached	How I marked it
24 hours		
72 hours (for many people, the hardest stretch)		
1 week		
30 days		
60 days		
90 days (many people notice sleep, mood, and focus improving)		
6 months		
1 year		

At 90 days, add this: start being useful to one other person who's earlier than you. Not as a savior — as a witness. Nothing protects sobriety like being needed by somebody who's watching whether it's real.

PART VI

Roadmap: Breaking Generational Curses

6.1 What it is and what it isn't

It is: a way of naming patterns of sin, wound, and unhealed pain that can run down a family until somebody brings them into the light and changes course.

- "Visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children to the third and fourth generation" — Exodus 20:5
- "Our fathers sinned and are no more, and we bear their iniquities." — Lamentations 5:7

It isn't: God punishing you for what your grandfather did. Read Ezekiel 18 and Jeremiah 31:29–30 — God explicitly says the son does **not** bear the father's guilt. And Galatians 3:13 — "Christ redeemed us from the curse."

So how is it both? Because **guilt** doesn't transfer, but **consequence, pattern, wound, and access** absolutely do. You didn't inherit their sin. You inherited the *terrain*. The debt was paid; the door was left standing open, and nobody in four generations walked over and shut it.

That's your job. That's the whole assignment. You're the one who closes it.

Practical layers, all real at once:

- **Behavioral** — you learned it. Modeled, absorbed, normal to you.
- **Biological** — research on epigenetics suggests severe stress can affect how the next generation's bodies respond to stress. It is an active area of science, not a settled verdict, and it is not destiny.
- **Systemic** — poverty, incarceration, no education, no assets. Real walls.
- **Spiritual** — whatever a vow, a practice, or an unhealed wound opened that nobody ever brought to God.

You work all four with four different tools. Most people try one and wonder why it didn't hold.

6.2 Step 1 – Map the Bloodline

You can't break what you haven't named. Draw it. Three or four generations up if you can. Both sides.

For each person, note what ran through them:

Person / generation	Addiction	Abuse	Sexual sin / trafficking	Suicide / early death	Mental illness	Poverty	Abandonment	Occult / witchcraft	Rage	Infidelity	Incarceration
Me											
Mother											
Father											
Maternal grandmother											
Maternal grandfather											
Paternal grandmother											
Paternal grandfather											
Great-grandparents (any known)											

Person / generation	Addiction	Abuse	Sexual sin / trafficking	Suicide / early death	Mental illness	Poverty	Abandonment	Occult / witchcraft	Rage	Infidelity	Incarceration
Siblings											
My children											

Now look at the columns. Which ones have marks in three or more generations?

The patterns running in my line are:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Which of these has already touched my children or the generation after me?

That's why this is worth doing — for you, and for whoever comes after you.

6.3 Step 2 – Find the Entry Points

For each pattern, ask: **where did this get permission?**

- What did somebody in this line *do* — a covenant, an oath, a practice, a dedication, a betrayal, a killing, a dealing with spirits?
- What did somebody in this line *say* — a curse spoken over a child, "you'll never amount to anything," "you're just like your father," a death wish?
- What was done *to* this line — slavery, genocide, displacement, land taken, a family destroyed? (Corporate trauma is real and it runs.)
- What secret has this family kept? **Secrets are load-bearing walls for curses.** The thing nobody talks about is usually the thing with the most power.

The secret in my family that nobody says out loud:

Naming it here, on paper, often takes some of the weight off. Secrets grow in the dark.

6.4 Step 3 – Repent for the Line (Identificational Repentance)

Many believers find this meaningful. It is based on how Daniel, Nehemiah, and Ezra prayed for their people. It is a practice to consider, not a requirement for your freedom, and it is not a magic formula. If it does not sit right with you, skip to Step 4 and talk it through with a pastor you trust.

You are not confessing their guilt as if it's yours. You are **standing in the gap, as someone who belongs to that family, and agreeing with God about what is true.**

Biblical precedent: Daniel 9 (Daniel repents for Israel's sin, generations of it, including sins he did not commit). Nehemiah 1:6 – "I and my father's house have sinned." Leviticus 26:40 – "they shall confess their iniquity and the iniquity of their fathers."

Pray out loud, one pattern at a time:

PRAYER

"Father, I come as a son/daughter of this bloodline. I stand in the gap. I confess and agree with You that [pattern — addiction, violence, sexual sin, witchcraft, abandonment, whatever] has run in my family line. I do not defend it. I do not excuse it. I do not hide it anymore.

I confess the sins of my ancestors in this area — known and unknown — and I confess my own participation and agreement with it. [Name your own part.]

I ask Your forgiveness for my line, on the basis of the blood of Jesus Christ, which is more than enough.

I bring to the cross of Christ every covenant, vow, oath, dedication, harsh word, and agreement made by anyone in my family line that has shaped us for harm, and I ask You to cancel its hold.

I renounce [pattern] as having any right to me, my body, my mind, my marriage, my finances, my children, or any generation after me.

Jesus, I place myself, my children, and my family line under Your protection. Anything that is not from You — any lie, pattern, or influence that has run through [pattern] — I resist in Your name. Do not let it pass on to my children.

Lord, I ask You to establish a new pattern in this line, starting with me. Let it be said that it stopped here. Amen."

If you choose to pray this, do it once for every pattern on your list. One at a time, specifically, out loud.

Pattern	Date renounced

Pattern	Date renounced

6.5 Step 4 – Break Your Own Agreements with It

A pattern keeps going when we keep agreeing with it, and you have probably been doing that without knowing.

Things I've said or believed that agreed with the pattern:

- "It's just how we are."
- "Everybody in my family is like this."
- "I'm turning into my mother/father."
- "Addiction runs in my family so I was always going to..."
- "We don't do money."
- "Nobody in my family stays married."
- "We die young."

Write yours:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Break each one out loud: "I renounce the agreement I made when I said '_____' That is not prophecy, it is a pattern, and patterns end. I break it in Jesus' name."

Now replace it: "The truth is: _____"

6.6 Step 5 – Change the Behavior (the Part Prayer Doesn't Do for You)

Here's the unfiltered part: **you can renounce a curse perfectly and still repeat it, because you learned the behavior and nobody has taught you a different one.**

Deliverance closes the door. **Discipleship builds the new house.** You need both or you'll be doing this same prayer next year.

For each pattern, name the concrete behavior and the concrete replacement:

Pattern	The behavior I inherited	The new behavior I'm building	How I'll practice it this week
e.g. rage	Yelling when scared	Naming fear out loud, walking out for 10 min	Tell my kid the plan so they can hold me to it

Where do I get the new behavior from? You have to see it modeled. Find someone who does the thing you never learned — marriage, money, parenting, anger, rest — and get close enough to watch. **You cannot imagine your way into a pattern you've never seen.**

Who I'm going to learn from:

6.7 Step 6 – Honor Without Repeating

You can honor your parents and refuse their pattern. Both. Simultaneously. It is not betrayal to be the one who stopped it.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"Honor your father and mother." — and also — "Whoever loves father or mother more than me is not worthy of me." (Matthew 10:37)

Honor is not obedience, agreement, access, or silence. Honor means you don't degrade them, you don't build your identity on hating them, and you don't hand your life to them as payment.

What I can genuinely honor about where I came from:

What I am refusing to carry forward:

6.8 Step 7 – Establish the New Covenant Line

Don't just close a door. **Build something.**

Write it. Out loud. Then put it somewhere your kids can read it.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

THE LINE STOPS HERE

I, _____, declare before God that the following ends with me and does not pass to the generation after me:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

And I declare that the following BEGINS with me in this bloodline:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

I can be the pivot. I am choosing to help what was meant to bury my family become something that frees it.

Signed: _____ Date: _____

Then: bless your children out loud, by name, regularly. Words can wound and words can bless. Speak over them what nobody spoke over you.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I dedicate my children and my children's children to the Lord. They are not the enemy's inheritance. They are God's."

PART VII

Letting People Go, and Sitting Silent with God

7.1 Why letting go is the hardest page in the book

Because you're not letting go of a person. You're letting go of:

- the version of them you needed them to become
- the apology you're still owed
- the hope that this time it would be different
- the role you've played your whole life
- and the belief that if you hold on hard enough, love will finally show up

You are grieving something that never existed. That's why it hurts worse than a funeral. There's no body and nobody sends flowers.

7.2 The four kinds of letting go

Type	What it means	The hard truth
Release to God	They stay in your life, you stop carrying their outcome	You can love someone and not be their savior
Boundary	They stay, with limits	Boundaries are not punishments; they're property lines
Distance	Less access, not zero	You can go low-contact without a declaration
Cut off	No contact	Sometimes required. Sometimes the only way anyone survives

You are not obligated to give unlimited access to someone who is actively harming you, and no Scripture requires it. Jesus withdrew constantly (Luke 5:16, John 6:15). Paul named people and said avoid them (2 Timothy 4:14–15, Romans 16:17). "Turn the other cheek" was about personal insult, not standing in a house fire.

WORK PAGE 16 — SORTING YOUR PEOPLE

Person	What they give	What they cost	Which of the four	Next step

7.3 The honest diagnostic — is this letting go, or is it quitting on someone?

Run it through:

- Am I leaving because they're harming me, or because they're **inconvenient** to my new life? (Those are different.)
- Have I told them the truth clearly, at least once, when I wasn't in a rage?
- Am I cutting them off to punish them, or to survive?
- If they changed, would I actually want them back — or am I done regardless? (Both answers are allowed. Know which it is.)
- Am I repeating the abandonment I received, or breaking the enmeshment I was raised in?
- Would I advise someone I love to stay in this?

What came up:

7.4 The specific one: letting go of someone still using

This is its own hell, and if you've lost someone to it, read this slowly.

What you can do: love them, tell the truth, keep the door of relationship open while closing the door of enabling, keep Narcan in your house, know the number to call, pray without ceasing, and be someone they can come back to.

What you cannot do: want it more than they do and have that work. Save someone who isn't reaching. Control the outcome. Be the reason. Trade your life for theirs.

The hardest sentence in this workbook: You can do everything right and still lose them.

And here's the other side of it: **if you lost someone, that does not mean you did it wrong.** It means addiction is lethal and they were sick and you were not God. Read that again. You were not, and are not, God. That was never your job and it was never in your hands.

WORK PAGE 17 — FOR THE ONE YOU LOST OR MIGHT LOSE

What I did do for them:

What I keep telling myself I should have done:

Was that actually in my power? _____ Who in this story was responsible for what?

Responsible for	Who
Their choices	
The people who hurt them	
The system that failed them	
The disease itself	
My choices	

Say it: "I loved them. I was not their God. I put them in the hands of the One who is, and I will carry their name forward into the work instead of carrying their death as a debt."

7.5 How to actually do it — the release

Don't do this halfway. Halfway is how you end up doing it fourteen times.

Step 1 — Say the truth about what it was. Out loud. Not the sanitized version. Not the villain version either. The true one.

Step 2 — Grieve it like a death. Because it is one. Let yourself cry for a person who is still alive. This is legitimate grief and it needs the same space.

Step 3 — Forgive without reconciling. Forgiveness is between you and God. Reconciliation requires two people and repentance. **You can be fully forgiving and fully unavailable.** Nobody taught us that and it changes everything.

Step 4 — Return what's theirs.

SAY IT OUT LOUD

"I give back the shame that was never mine. I give back the blame. I give back the story they wrote about me. I give back the responsibility for their choices. I take back my name, my voice, my body, my future, and my peace."

Step 5 — Release the hold. (2.6, Step 6.)

Step 6 — Set the actual boundary in the actual world. Block the number. Change the lock. Tell the family member who relays messages to stop. Boundaries that exist only in your heart are wishes.

Step 7 — Plan for the pullback. They will reach out. Usually right when you get peaceful. Decide now what you'll do, because deciding in the moment is how you get pulled back in.

When they reach out, I will:

Step 8 — Replace the space. A cut-off leaves a hole and holes get filled by whatever's nearest. Put something in it on purpose — people, work, service, God.

WORK PAGE 18 — THE RELEASE DECLARATION

SAY IT OUT LOUD

I release _____ into the hands of God.

I am not their savior, their judge, their jailer, or their payment.

What was good, I keep. What was mine, I take back. What was theirs, I return.

I forgive them. I am not available for more harm.

The boundary I am setting is: _____

The date I set it: ____ / ____ / ____

7.6 Sitting Silent with God

This is the last section because it's the one that holds everything else up. And it's the one you'll resist most, because silence is where the pain lives and you've spent your whole life outrunning it.

WHY SILENCE IS THE HARDEST SPIRITUAL DISCIPLINE FOR SURVIVORS

Noise was safety. If it was quiet, you could hear them coming. If it was quiet, you had to feel it. So you filled every second — music, TV, scrolling, people, work, using. You are not undisciplined. **You are guarded.**

Silence will feel like danger before it feels like peace. That's not failure. That's a nervous system that learned quiet meant something bad was about to happen.

WHAT THE SCRIPTURE ACTUALLY SAYS

- **1 Kings 19:11–12** — Elijah, suicidal and burned out, looks for God in wind, earthquake, fire. God's in "a sound of thin silence." The whisper comes *after* God feeds him and lets him sleep twice. **Note the order: food, sleep, then the whisper.** God did not rebuke his exhaustion. He fed it.
- **Psalms 46:10** — "Be still and know." The Hebrew *rapha* is closer to "let go, drop your hands, stop striving."
- **Psalms 62:1** — "For God alone my soul waits in silence."
- **Lamentations 3:26** — "It is good that one should wait quietly for the salvation of the LORD."
- **Isaiah 30:15** — "In returning and rest you shall be saved; in quietness and in trust shall be your strength." And then, brutally honest: "But you were unwilling."

THE PRACTICE — START ABSURDLY SMALL

Week 1 — 2 minutes a day. Yes, two. Sit. Feet on the floor. Eyes open if closed feels unsafe — that's allowed and it's smart. Say once: "Jesus, I'm here. You don't have to say anything. I'm not going anywhere for two minutes."

Then nothing. No agenda. No asking. No performance.

When your mind runs — and it will — don't fight it. Say "later" and come back. You'll come back forty times in two minutes. **Coming back IS the practice.** The returning is the prayer.

Week 2 — 5 minutes. Week 3 — 10 minutes. Week 4 — 15 minutes. Stay here. 15 minutes daily beats an hour on Sunday.

WHAT TO DO WHEN SILENCE GETS LOUD

What comes up	What to do
Panic / tight chest	Open your eyes. Orient (look at all four corners). Breathe 4-7-8. Come back tomorrow, shorter. You are not failing.
Memories flooding	Keep a notebook beside you. Write the memory down, one line. Tell it "you're on the list." Return to the silence.

What comes up	What to do
Rage	Let it be there. Rage in God's presence is biblical. Read a psalm of imprecation out loud if you need words.
Accusation ("God's disgusted with you")	That voice isn't His. Answer it once — "Romans 8:1" — and return. Don't argue with it.
Nothing at all, for weeks	Normal. Faithfulness in the dry season is worth more than ecstasy in the easy one. Keep showing up.
You fall asleep	Then you needed sleep. God is not offended. Elijah slept twice before the whisper.

THE FOUR POSTURES OF SILENCE

Rotate these. Don't do just one.

1. **Silent presence** — nothing. Just there. "I'm here."
2. **Silent listening** — one question, then quiet. "What do You want me to know today?" Then wait. Write down what comes; test it later against Scripture and wise people. If it accuses, shames, or condemns you, it isn't Him.
3. **Silent surrender** — hands open, palms up. Physically hand over one thing. Name it. Leave it. Go.
4. **Silent lament** — sit with the grief without fixing it. Don't explain it to God. Don't excuse Him. Just bring it. Psalm 88 ends in darkness and God still printed it.

WORK PAGE 19 — SILENCE LOG (FIRST 30 DAYS)

Day	Minutes	What came up	What I heard, if anything
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

(Continue on your own paper through day 30.)

After 30 days, answer: What changed in me?

What did I hear most consistently?

What am I still afraid to hear?

CLOSING

The Commission

THE HOLY R3UP

You have now done work most people never do. Not because they're weaker — because nobody handed them the pages.

Here's what's true now:

What happened to you was real. Nobody gets to minimize it, including you.

What you did while surviving is forgiven. Not excused — paid for. Stop billing yourself.

The spiritual realm is real, and you are not helpless in it. You belong to Christ, who has already won. Seated with Him, not cowering.

Being chosen cost you what it costs everybody. You are not being punished. God can use what you have been through, and He does not waste it.

The addiction is breakable. Not by willpower — by architecture, honesty, community, medicine where needed, and the Spirit of God. Step by step, day by day, one craving at a time.

You can be the one who changes the pattern. That can feel like a burden. It can also be the beginning of something good.

You are allowed to let people go. Even blood. Even the ones you love. Loving someone does not require you to die with them.

And you are allowed to sit down and be quiet with God, and bring Him nothing, and produce nothing, and still be fully His.

For Brandi Renee.

And for every person who is going to find this in the middle of the night and finally realize somebody wrote it down for them.

The place you wished existed — you're building it. That's the answer to the prayer nobody heard you pray.

LOOKING BACK

Final Reflection

Take your time. Answer in pencil if that feels safer. You are not grading yourself — you are noticing.

WHAT IS ONE THING I TOLD THE TRUTH ABOUT THAT I HAD BEEN AVOIDING?

WHERE DID I FEEL THE MOST RESISTANCE, AND WHAT MIGHT THAT BE PROTECTING?

WHAT IS ONE THING THAT IS DIFFERENT — EVEN SLIGHTLY — FROM WHEN I STARTED?

WHAT DO I STILL NEED HELP WITH, AND WHO COULD I ASK?

PROGRESS REVIEW

Where I Am Now

Fill this in honestly. “Still hard” is an allowed answer. Finishing is not the same as being finished.

Part	What I finished or practiced	What shifted	What still needs care
I • Trauma			
II • The Spiritual Realm			
III • The Chosen One			
IV • Addiction and Abuse			
V • Breaking Addiction			
VI • Generational Patterns			
VII • Letting Go and Silence			

YOUR NEXT STEP

Next-Step Challenge

SAY IT OUT LOUD

Pick one Work Page you skipped or rushed. Go back to it this week — with a safe person nearby if you can — and write one honest paragraph. Then tell one person you did.

MY ONE NEXT STEP

WHO WILL KNOW ABOUT IT, AND BY WHEN?

WHAT WILL I DO IF I MISS A DAY?

Pick the page back up. Missing a day is not failure — the identity is in the rising.

Closing Prayer

PRAYER

Father, thank You for walking with me through these pages. I did not do this perfectly, and You never asked me to. Where I told the truth, thank You for staying. Where I skipped, meet me there with patience. Where I found grief, hold me in it. Where I found anger, let me bring it to You instead of away from You. Give me safe people, good help, and a next step small enough to take. Keep me honest without letting me shame myself. Teach me to tend what You have given me — slowly, the way a vineyard is tended. I belong to You, and I am still building. In Jesus' name. Amen.

THE HOLY R3UP

Certificate of Completion

This certifies that

Participant's name

has completed

*Trauma and the Spiritual Realm
Workbook*

with honesty, courage, and grace for the days that were hard. Brokenness is not the destination. Keep going — one next step at a time.

Signature

Date

You survived. Now we rebuild.

THE HOLY R3UP & CO.

KEEP THIS PAGE

Help, Right Now

If you are in danger right now, or the thought of dying has teeth in it today, stop reading and call. That is not failure. That is the correct use of this page.

Need	Contact
988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline	Call or text 988 · free, 24/7, confidential
Crisis Text Line	Text HOME to 741741
SAMHSA National Helpline (substance use, treatment referrals)	1-800-662-4357 · free, 24/7, confidential
National Domestic Violence Hotline	1-800-799-7233, or text START to 88788
RAINN (sexual assault)	1-800-656-4673
National Human Trafficking Hotline	1-888-373-7888, or text 233733
Veterans Crisis Line	Dial 988, then press 1

GOOD TO KNOW

- **Narcan (naloxone)** is available without an individual prescription at most pharmacies, and free through many health departments and harm-reduction programs. Keep it in the house even if you do not use. It can reverse an opioid overdose and will not hurt someone who did not take opioids.
- **Withdrawal from alcohol, benzodiazepines, and barbiturates can kill you.** Do not detox from those alone. That is a medical detox, not a willpower problem. Call SAMHSA or go to an emergency room.
- Numbers and services change. Confirm them before you rely on them.

MY PEOPLE

Role	Name	Number
Knows everything		
Further ahead		
Behind me		
Just a friend		
Can correct me		

Reaching back. Freeing the bound.

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